

Marketing – Specialization in Digital Marketing

CORE LEARNING LOGIC

**CLARITY → ESSENTIALS → DECISION GATE → EXECUTION → BRAND → DEMAND
→ REVENUE → SCALE**

LEARNING ARCHITECTURE:

In-Class (30–40%) → Strategy, frameworks, decision logic.

“WHY + WHAT + HOW MUCH”

Out-Class (60–70%) → Real-world simulations via The CEO Challenge

“DO + DECIDE + DEFEND”

STRUCTURE OF THE CEO CHALLENGE

Core Rule One line.

“One real problem. One instant solution” “Timing + insight + action”

PHASE 1: WHAT MARKETING REALLY IS (CLARITY FIRST)

MODULE 1: WHAT MARKETING REALLY IS

Purpose: Remove confusion. Build confidence.

In-Class

- Brand vs Business vs Product
- Marketing vs Sales vs Ads
- Why brands win over features
- Emotional vs functional branding
- Long-term brand value vs short-term performance

Out-Class (Light CEO Challenge)

“Pick any brand you like. Why do people remember it?”

Outcome:

Students understand marketing ≠ ads.

PHASE 2: CUSTOMER & MARKET UNDERSTANDING (ESSENTIAL THINKING)

MODULE 2: CUSTOMER & MARKET UNDERSTANDING

In-Class

- Consumer behaviour fundamentals
- Customer journey ($A \rightarrow C \rightarrow R \rightarrow L$)
- Persona creation (demographic + psychographic)
- Pain points, fears, desires, trust triggers

Out-Class

“Describe one customer so clearly that we can sell to them.”

Outcome:

Students start thinking from the customer’s mind.

PHASE 3: FUNNELS & BASIC METRICS (FLOW BEFORE TOOLS)

MODULE 3: FUNNELS & BASIC METRICS

In-Class

- Funnel basics (Awareness → Conversion → Retention)
- How users move and drop
- Core metrics:
 - CTR
 - Leads
 - Conversions
 - Revenue (basic understanding)

Out-Class

“Fix a broken funnel using logic, not ads.”

Outcome:

Student understands flow before execution.

PHASE 4: IDEA CLARITY & PROBLEM DISCOVERY (MANDATORY GATE)

Students cannot move forward without passing this phase

MODULE 4: IDEA CLARITY & PROBLEM DISCOVERY

Purpose: Decide *what is worth solving*

In-Class (WHY)

- Idea vs problem vs opportunity
- Why most ideas fail (founder ego vs market pain)
- Pain-first thinking
- Founder mindset vs marketer mindset
- What makes a problem worth solving

Decision Frameworks (Explicit)

- Problem – Pain – Person mapping
- Frequency × Intensity × Urgency filter

Out-Class (CEO GATE CHALLENGE)

Problem:

“What exactly am I trying to solve — and for whom?”

Student must submit:

- Clear problem statement
- Who faces it
- How often it occurs
- Why current solutions fail

CEO KPI:

“Would I allow my team to work on this problem?”

PHASE 5: IDEA → MARKET EXECUTION (MAKE IT HAPPEN CORE)

MODULE 5: IDEA → MARKET (0 → 1)

In-Class

1. Market Validation

- Market size reality check
- Demand signals (search, behaviour, substitutes)
- Willingness-to-pay logic
- Competitor substitution (not just competition)

2. Offer Design

- Product / service definition
- Feature → benefit → outcome mapping
- Pricing anchors
- Risk reversal (guarantees, trials)
- Packaging & differentiation

3. MVP & Proof of Demand

- What a real MVP is
- No-code MVPs
- Landing-page-first validation
- Pre-orders, demos, waitlists

4. Go-To-Market (GTM)

- Beachhead market selection
- Early adopters vs mass market
- Launch vs scale messaging
- First traction channels

Out-Class (CORE CEO CHALLENGE)

“You have an idea. No brand. No users.
Get first customers — or kill it.”

Outcome:

“I’ve actually launched something.”

PHASE 6: BRAND STRATEGY & MARKET POSITIONING (AFTER PROOF)

MODULE 6: BRAND STRATEGY & MARKET POSITIONING

In-Class

Understanding Brand

- Brand vs business vs product
- Brand perception & memory
- Emotional vs functional branding

Brand DNA & Brand Kits

- Purpose, vision, mission
- Values & ethics
- Voice & tone
- Brand promise & positioning

Visual Identity Basics

- Logo philosophy
- Color psychology
- Typography
- Brand consistency across platforms

Strategic Brand Blueprint

- Market research & competitor mapping
- STP framework
- Value proposition design
- Brand growth roadmap

Out-Class (CEO Challenge)

“No one remembers your brand. Fix it without increasing ad spend.”

Outcome:

Brand designed to sell, not decorate.

PHASE 7: MEDIA STRATEGY & DEMAND SYSTEMS

MODULE 7: MEDIA STRATEGY & MEDIA PLANNING

In-Class

- SEO + website Building (WordPress / Wix)
- Demand vs intent vs retention media
- Budget allocation logic
- Channel roles:
 - Google (Search, YouTube, PMAX, Demand Gen)
 - Meta (FB, IG, Reels, CBO)
 - Marketplaces
 - Influencers & affiliates
- Media mix modeling (MMM – conceptual)

Out-Class

“Map channels to revenue stages.”

MODULE 7A: SEARCH & WEBSITE ECOSYSTEM (DEEP DIVE)

In-Class (WHY + WHAT)

- Search ecosystem overview (Google as demand mirror)
- Search intent types:
 - Informational
 - Commercial
 - Transactional
- How websites influence:
 - Trust
 - Conversion
 - Quality Score
- SEO vs Paid Search roles

Skills Covered (IN DETAIL)

SEO (Deep)

- Keyword research (intent-based)
- On-page SEO
- Technical SEO (basics)
- Content SEO vs landing SEO
- SEO for brand demand vs generic demand
- SEO metrics that matter (not vanity)

Website Design (Practical)

- Website structure for funnels
- UX for conversion
- Landing pages vs websites

- WordPress / Wix:
 - Page structure
 - Speed basics
 - CTA placement

MODULE 7B: GOOGLE ADS ECOSYSTEM

In-Class (WHY + WHAT)

- Google Ads ecosystem overview
- When Google works, when it doesn't
- Budget logic & intent matching

Skills Covered (IN DETAIL)

Google Ads:

- Search Ads (Text Ads)
- Display Ads - Google Display (Audience Targeting & Placements, Responsive Display Ads Setup)
- YouTube / Video Ads
- Performance Max
- PLA / Shopping Ads
- Google Merchant Center setup (overview)

Execution Concepts:

- Keyword match types
- Bidding strategies
- Ad copy writing (intent-based)
- Quality Score logic

Analytics Integration

- Conversion tracking
- GA4 + GTM integration
- Event tracking basics

AI Integration:

- Generate banners via Canva Magic Studio / Leonardo AI
- AI-based creative prompt generation
- Test creatives using Smart Creative AI

MODULE 7C: META & SOCIAL MEDIA ECOSYSTEM

In-Class (WHY + WHAT)

- Social platforms as **attention engines**
 - Organic vs paid roles
 - Why algorithms reward retention, not posting
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Skills Covered (IN DETAIL)

Social Media Marketing (Organic)

- Platforms:
 - Instagram
 - Facebook
 - X (Twitter)
 - LinkedIn (overview)
- Algorithm basics
- Engagement rate calculation
- Hook & Hold ratios
- Content formats:
 - Reels
 - Static
 - Carousel
- Consistency vs virality

Meta Ads (Paid)

- Campaign objectives

- Audience structures
- Pixel & CAPI basics
- Creative testing logic
- Scaling frameworks

Influencer Marketing:

MODULE 7D: OWNED MEDIA & DIRECT RESPONSE MARKETING

Skills Covered

WhatsApp Marketing

- Broadcast vs automation
- Use cases by funnel stage

Email Marketing

- Lifecycle emails
- Nurturing vs selling
- Metrics that matter

SMS Marketing

- Timing & compliance
- High-intent use cases

ORM (Online Reputation Management)

- Reviews & ratings
- Brand trust loops
- Crisis handling basics

MODULE 8: CONTENT MARKETING & BRAND STORYTELLING

In-Class (WHY + WHAT)

- Why content compounds
- Content ≠ posting
- Content across funnel stages

Skills Covered (IN DETAIL)

- Content strategy (brand + performance)
- Persona re-use (from Module 2)
- Content writing:
 - Ads
 - Blogs
 - Social
 - Landing pages
- Content creation workflows
- Content calendar planning
- Repurposing frameworks

MODULE 9: MEDIA BUYING & PERFORMANCE EXECUTION

In-Class

- Campaign structures & bidding logic
- Creative hooks (UGC, reels, statics)
- Scaling frameworks
- Platform algorithm logic (high-level)

Platforms

- Google Ads (Search, YouTube, Display, PMAX)
- Meta Ads (CBO, DPA, Catalog, Pixel, CAPI)
- Amazon Ads / DSP
- Quick commerce ads
- Native / Push (overview)

D2C, MARKETPLACE & OMNICHANNEL GROWTH (High-paying specialization)

In-Class:

- D2C vs Marketplace economics
- 1P vs 3P models
- Pricing ladders & discount traps
- SKU lifecycle management
- Seasonality (India-specific)

Platforms Covered: Amazon (SPN, Brand Analytics, DSP)

Flipkart Ads & Assured, Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart

Tools: Unicommerce, Assiduus

Out-Class: “CTR is good. ROAS is not. Fix it.”

PHASE 8: MARKET, MONEY & REVENUE OPERATIONS

MODULE 10: MARKET, MONEY & BUSINESS FOUNDATIONS

In-Class

- How businesses actually make money
- Business models:
 - B2C, B2B, D2C, SaaS, Marketplace, Agency
- Revenue models & cash-flow logic
- Unit economics:
 - CAC
 - LTV
 - Gross Margin
 - Contribution Margin
- Break-even & scalability logic
- Why brands fail despite “good marketing”

Outcome:

Students understand marketing's impact on cash.

MODULE 11: CONVERSION, SALES & REVENUE OPERATIONS

In-Class

- Funnel math (TOFU → BOFU → Loyalty)
- Sales scripts linked to ads
- Lead qualification frameworks
- CRM revenue pipelines
- Offer design & upsells
- Marketing–Sales handoff SOPs
- COD, RTO, Indian realities

Out-Class

“Increase revenue without increasing ad spend.”

PHASE 9: SYSTEMS, ANALYTICS & SCALE

MODULE 12: FUNNELS, AUTOMATION & AI-DRIVEN SCALE

In-Class

- Revenue-triggered automations
- Funnel math (TOFU → BOFU → Loyalty)
- Funnel lifecycle logic
- CRM & automation tools, CRM pipelines
- Automation logic (what to automate, what not), AI in marketing systems
- Scaling without headcount

Problem: “Leads doubled. The team is overloaded.” Outcome: System builders, not manual operators.

MODULE 13: ANALYTICS, TRACKING & PROFIT OPTIMIZATION

In-Class

- GA4, GTM, UTMs
- Funnel & cohort analysis
- CAC, ROAS, LTV, payback
- Budget vs actuals
- Attribution vs incrementality
- Retargeting for closing, not awareness

Out-Class

“Find the revenue leak.”

Focus shift:

From impressions → profit

From CTR → CAC

From leads → revenue per lead
Retargeting for closing, not awareness

Tools:

1. GA4, Looker Studio
2. Excel / Google Sheets (pivot tables)
3. Voluum, RedTrack, Ringba (overview)

PHASE 10: ORGANIC, RETENTION & BRAND LEADERSHIP

MODULE 14: ORGANIC GROWTH & RETENTION

In-Class

- SEO for long-term brand demand
- Content ecosystems
- Community-led growth
- Retention loops
- Loyalty & referrals
- Repeat purchase psychology

Out-Class

“Reduce dependency on paid ads.”

MODULE 15: POST-LAUNCH, SCALE & BRAND LEADERSHIP

In-Class

- Market expansion
- Brand evolution
- Crisis & reputation management
- Leadership thinking

Outcome:

Future Heads of Marketing / Growth.

CEO CHALLENGE: “MAKE IT HAPPEN”

The One-Line Problem: “You have an idea. No brand. No users. No proof. You must get your first customers.

“Make this brand memorable AND sellable.

Student Must Deliver (REAL OUTPUTS):

STEP 1: PICK THE BET (NO DISTRACTIONS)

1. Choose ONE Idea

- Product or service
- Can be built or delivered immediately
- Solves a real business or consumer pain

CEOs don't test multiple ideas at once.

STEP 2: DEFINE THE REAL PROBLEM

2. Problem Statement

- Who exactly has the problem?
- What pain do they feel daily?
- Why existing options don't work?
- What happens if the problem stays unsolved?

If the problem isn't painful, nothing else matters.

3. Problem Clarity Check (CEO Filter)

- Is the pain urgent?
- Is money or growth at risk?
- Would *you* pay to fix this?

If not → kill it early

STEP 3: MARKET REALITY CHECK

4. Target Market Definition

- Specific customer type (role / age / income)
- Clear buying power
- Easy to reach today

“Everyone” is not a market.

5. Market Logic

- How many such customers exist *now*?
- Where do they already hang out?
- Can you reach them in **under 7 days**?

If access is hard → growth will be hard.

STEP 4: BUILD A SELLABLE OFFER

6. Offer Design

- What exactly are you selling?
- What does the customer receive on Day 1?

Keep it simple. Sell outcomes, not features.

7. Pricing

- Price based on:
 - Value created
 - Urgency of pain
 - Ability to pay

Free is allowed only if it leads to paid fast.

8. Strength of Offer (CEO Test)

- Is this clearly better than alternatives?
- Can it be explained in 1 sentence?
- Would someone buy this *today*?

STEP 5: VALIDATE BEFORE YOU SCALE

9. Validation Hypothesis

“If this problem is real, customers will take real action.”

10. Validation Experiment

- Channel: DMs / calls / WhatsApp / landing page
- Message: problem-first
- CTA: pay / book / reply

No surveys. No opinions.

11. Validate Demand with Real Signals

Only these count:

- Payments
- Booked calls
- Pre-orders
- Direct interest messages

Likes don't pay salaries.

12. Speed of Validation.

STEP 6: LAUNCH & EXECUTE

13. GTM Plan

- One primary channel
- One core message
- Daily execution plan

Start small. Win small. Then scale.

14. Launch-Ready Plan

- Day 1–2: Setup
- Day 3–7: Outreach
- Day 8–14: Close + feedback

No “soft launches”.

STEP 7: MEASURE WHAT MATTERS

15. Success Metrics (Mandatory)

- Leads
- Conversion rate
- Revenue
- Time to first customer

If revenue = 0 → idea is not validated.

16. Revenue Potential

- Can this repeat?
- Can this reach meaningful monthly revenue?
- Is there scope to expand?

CEOs build businesses, not experiments.

STEP 8: CONSTRAINTS (REAL WORLD)

17. Operating Constraints

- Limited budget
- Time pressure
- No “assume it will work”

Constraints force clarity.

STEP 9: FINAL CEO DECISION

18. Go / Pivot / Kill

Decide based on:

- Clarity of problem
- Strength of offer
- Market logic
- Speed of validation
- Revenue potential

Weak ideas are killed fast. Strong ones get resources.

CEO RULEBOOK (FINAL)

- Opinions don't matter
- Assumptions are expensive
- Revenue is truth
- Speed beats perfection

CEO KPI: 👉 “Would a real company approve this launch?”